

CURRENT AFFAIRS



**WHY ?
&
HOW ?**



1st WEEK

1st January to 6th January, 2019

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472 Norway's Wind Park and
Affect on Reindeer

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Release of Civilian Prisoners

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A fortnight ahead of the Kumbh Mela, the Centre approved the renaming of Allahabad as Prayagraj, as sought by the Uttar Pradesh Government.



सत्यमेव जयते

Ministry of External Affairs
Government of India

SALIENT POINTS

- Yogi Adityanath Government took the decision to rename the historic city as Prayagraj.
- Kumbh Mela in Prayagraj will start on January 15 on Makar Sankranti and will conclude on March 4 on Maha Shivaratri.
- The proposal to rename Uttar Pradesh Faizabad district to Ayodhya district is yet to be received from the State.
- The proposal to rename West Bengal as Bangla is pending, as the Ministry of External Affairs expressed its reservations.

WHAT IS THE PROCEDURE FOR RENAMING CITIES / TOWNS / VILLAGES?

- Union Home Ministry considers the proposals of name change, according to the existing guidelines.
- It gives its approval to the change of the name of any place, after taking no objections from the Ministry of Railways, Department of Posts, Survey of India.
- These have to confirm that there is no such a city, town or village in their records with similar name to the proposed one.
- For changing the name of a village or town or a city, an executive order is enough.
- The renaming of a State requires amendment to the Constitution with simple majority in Parliament.



Ministry of Home Affairs
Government of India



Ministry of Railway
Government of India



Department of Post
Ministry of Communications & IT
Government of India



Survey of India

472 ISSUE

Norway is going to build a wind park in an area used for reindeer grazing, despite United Nations calls to suspend the project.



As per the Arctic Report Card, 2018 released by NOAA, there is decline in reindeer population. During the last two decades, the population declined by 56% from 4.7 million animals to 2.1 million.

SALIENT POINTS

- The Government said that it would proceed with the 288 MW Storheia Wind Farm, which is part of Europe's largest onshore wind power project.
- UN said that it would disturb reindeer herding, a traditional activity of the Sami people.



A map of Norway is shown in yellow, with a red label 'NORWAY' pointing to it. The map is set against a blue background representing the sea. Other landmasses are visible in the background, including parts of Sweden and Finland.

NORWAY



WHY THE REINDEER WOULD BE AFFECTED?

- Sight and sound of the turbines in the park, to be built in an area on Norway's northwest coast could frighten the animals.
- This area is used as pastures during winter months.



WHAT ARE THE CAUSES FOR DECLINE?

- 1 They include disease, hunting and diminished food availability and climate change.
- 2 Longer, warmer summers led to boom in disease causing parasites.
- 3 Heat stress also leads to increased susceptibility to pathogens

Reindeer is found in northern regions of North America, Europe, Asia and Greenland. Reindeer and Caribou are the same animal, they are the members of the species Rangifer Tarandus.

WHY REINDEER IS SO IMPORTANT IN THE ARCTIC ECOSYSTEM?

- 1 They are the source of food, clothing and livelihood for the local people.
- 2 Massive herds of deer roam the tundra region, shaping the vegetation of the region by grazing.



India and Pakistan move towards the release of civilian prisoners.



SALIENT POINTS

- Both the countries exchanged the list of prisoners on January 1, 2019 as part of 2008 Agreement.
- 249 civilian prisoners and 98 fishermen are there in India and 54 civilian prisoners and 483 fishermen are in Pakistan, who belongs to India.

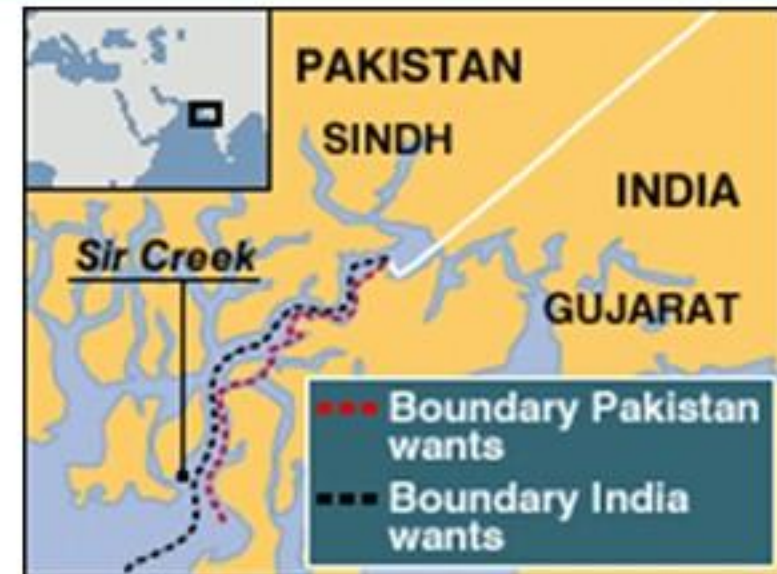
WHAT IS THIS 2008 AGREEMENT?

- 1 There is Consular Access Agreement of May 21, 2008.
- 2 As per this agreement, both the countries are required to exchange lists of prisoners in each other's custody twice a year i.e., on January 1 & July 1.



WHY THE CIVILIANS AND FISHERMEN ARE IN THE JAILS?

- Due to the spying charges.
- Going beyond the maritime zones, while fishing.
- Because of the Sir Creek Dispute.



The recent decision of the Government will enhance Confidence Building Measures.

Cinereous Vulture was seen in Jharkhand and it is a rare sight as per the bird watchers.



SALIENT POINTS

- It has a black tipped pink beak.
- It migrates from mountainous regions of Europe and Asia to warmer places, including India.
- It is normally seen in Northern parts of India up to Rajasthan, but it is now seen in Hazaribagh, Jharkhand.
- It is “Near Threatened”, as per IUCN Red List.



Rajasthan Government decided to scrap minimum educational requirements for contesting local body elections.



सत्यमेव जयते

Government of Rajasthan



WHAT WERE THE PREVIOUS STIPULATIONS?

Through an Ordinance in December 2014, the qualification of Class X pass was set for Zila Parishad and Panchayat Samiti Polls and Class VIII pass for Sarpanch elections.

Rajasthan Government's decision should also force a rethink in Haryana, where in 2015, a series of eligibility requirements were introduced for Panchayat elections.

The Prime Minister announced renaming of three islands in Andaman and Nicobar Islands.



SALIENT POINTS

- Ross Island is now Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Dweep.
- Neil Island is Shaheed Dweep.
- Havelock Island is Swaraj Dweep.

All three are in South Andaman District.

1 NETAJI SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE DWEEP



- 1 It is Ross Island.
- 2 It was once a settlement, where the British established a penal colony and later buildings including troop barracks were constructed.
- 3 It was gradually abandoned following a massive earthquake and World War II.

2

SWARAJ DWEEP



- 1 This is Havelock Island. It is located at 39 Km north-east of Port Blair.
- 2 It is one of the biggest islands in the Andaman Group and the area is 113 sq.km.
- 3 It has several white sand beaches and rich coral reefs.
- 4 It has a population of around 5,354.
- 5 It also has lush green rainforest.

3

SHAHEED DWEEP



- 1 It is Neil Island.
- 2 It is a miniature version of Havelock Island, just south of it.
- 3 It's beaches are named after characters from the Ramayana like Laxmanpur, Sitapur and Ramnagar.
- 4 The island is 5 km across at its widest point.
- 5 In 2001, 2,868 people lived on it.

NORTH SENTINEL ISLAND
(SENTINELESE)

MIDDLE ANDAMAN
(JARAWAS)

STRAIT ISLAND
(ANDAMANESE)

SOUTH ANDAMAN
(JARAWAS)

LITTLE ANDAMAN
(ONGES)

ANDAMAN AND NICOBAR ISLANDS

ANDAMAN SEA

GREAT NICOBAR
(SHOMPENS)



Morocco is named the second best performing country after Sweden in Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI).



Climate Change Performance Index is released by Germanwatch, the NewClimate Institute and the Climate Action Network.

SALIENT POINTS

- The North African country increased the share of renewables over the past 5 years substantially.
- Sweden is in top position, followed by Morocco and Lithuania in the CCPI, 2019.
- The bottom five in the list are Saudi Arabia, US, Iran, South Korea and Taiwan.
- With the connection of the World's largest solar plant to the grid, Morocco is on track for achieving its target of 42% installed renewable energy capacities by 2020.



North
Atlantic
Ocean

MOROCCO

ALGERIA

LIBYA

EGYPT

SAUDI ARABIA

MAURITANIA

MALI

Niger

CHAD

SUDAN

YEMEN

NIGERIA

ETHIOPIA

SOMALIA

Gulf of Guinea

Cameroon

CENTRAL
AFRICAN
REPUBLIC

SOUTH SUDAN

UGANDA

KENYA

TANZANIA

DR CONGO

REPUBLIC
OF THE
CONGO

SPAIN

AUSTRIA

HUNGARY

ROMANIA

ITALY

SLOVAKIA

CROATIA

SERBIA

BULGARIA

Black Sea

TURKEY

Mediterranean Sea

SYRIA

IRAQ

IRAN

AFGHANISTAN

UZBEKISTAN

TURKMENISTAN

Learning Space

Learning Space

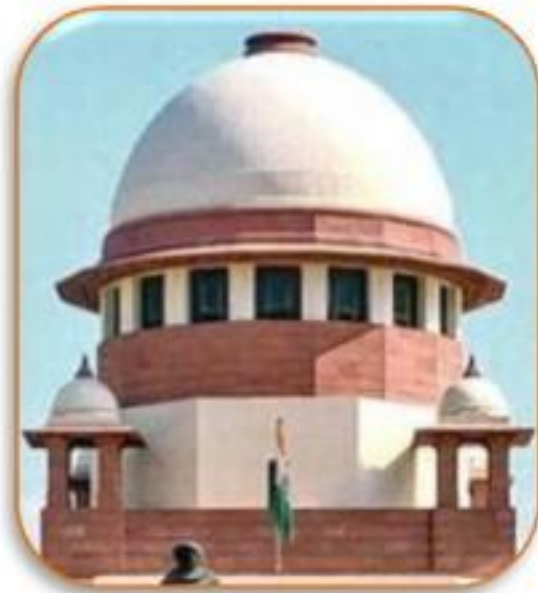
The dramatic collapse of the Indonesian volcano led to devastating tsunami in the Sunda Strait.



SALIENT POINTS

- Researchers examined satellite images of Anak Krakatau to calculate the amount of rock and ash that sheared off into the sea.
- Volcano has lost more than two-thirds of height and volume.
- Much of this missing mass could have slid into sea in one movement.
- It would explain displacement of water and the generation of waves to five metres high and then inundated the nearby coastlines of Java and Sumatra.

Supreme Court revives Class Action Suit against Nestle. It is the suit filed by the Government on behalf of thousands of consumers.



Class Action Suit is a type of Lawsuit, where one of the parties is a group of people, who are represented collectively by a member of that Group.

BRIEF HISTORY

- Stocks of Maggi were recalled on 5th June, 2015, when FSSAI alleged that some samples of noodles contained Monosodium Glutamate (MSG) and excess Lead.
- Union Government moved the National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission, alleging unfair trade practices, false labelling and misleading advertisements by Nestle and sought compensation of Rs. 640 Cr under provisions of Consumer Protection Act, 1986.
- In December 2015, the Supreme Court stayed NCDRC proceedings against Nestle and now revived it.

HOW THE GOVERNMENT CAME INTO PICTURE?



भारत सरकार
GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

उपभोक्ता मामले, खाद्य और सार्वजनिक वितरण मंत्रालय
MINISTRY OF CONSUMER AFFAIRS, FOOD & PUBLIC DISTRIBUTION



उपभोक्ता मामलों के विभाग
DEPARTMENT OF
CONSUMER AFFAIRS

*The suit was filed by the
Department of Consumer Affairs,
Ministry of Consumer Affairs,
Food and Public Distribution.*

- 1 The issue is with regard to the presence of Lead within permissible limits and the presence of Monosodium Glutamate (MSG), whether it is natural or added.
- 2 The suit was filed under Section 12 (1) (d) of the Consumer Protection Act, 1986.
- 3 The provision allows the Centre or the State either in its individual capacity or as the representative of the interests of consumers, to file a complaint in the consumer forum.



President Ramnath Kovind nominated justice A.K.Sikri as Executive Chairman of National Legal Services Authority. He replaced justice Madan B. Lokur

**A.K.SIKRI**

Executive Chairman,
NALSA

**MADAN B. LOKUR**

Former Executive Chairman,
NALSA



NATIONAL LEGAL SERVICES AUTHORITY



- 1 It is constituted under the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987.
- 2 It is to provide free legal services to the weaker sections of society.

It is to fulfil the provisions under the Article 39 A of the Constitution, which provides for free legal aid for the poor and weaker sections to promote justice. NALSA works in close coordination with various State Legal Services Authorities, District Legal Services Authorities etc.

- 3 NALSA organises Lok Adalats for amicable settlement of disputes.
- 4 Chief Justice of India is the Patron-in-Chief, senior most judge is the Executive Chairman of the Authority.
- 5 It identifies specific categories of marginalized and excluded groups from the diverse populace of the country and formulate various strategies for the implementation of preventive and strategic legal service programmes.



Japan decided to withdraw from the International Whaling Commission.



SALIENT POINTS

- It would enable Japan to resume Commercial Whaling activities.
- It would undertake commercial whaling in Japan's Territorial Waters and Exclusive Economic Zones.
- Japan said since most whale species are not endangered and eating whale is part of its culture, it decided to withdraw.



INTERNATIONAL
WHALING
COMMISSION



INTERNATIONAL
WHALING
COMMISSION

INTERNATIONAL WHALING COMMISSION



Uncertainty over whale numbers led to the introduction of a 'moratorium' on commercial whaling in 1986.

- 1 It was set up under the International Convention for the Regulation of Whaling on 2nd December, 1946 at Washington D.C.
- 2 It aims at providing for the proper conservation of whale stocks and make possible the orderly development of whaling industry.
- 3 It is accompanied by legally binding Schedule, which sets out specific measures that the IWC has collectively decided.

Kadaknath Chicken is once again in the news as the principal scientist of Jhabua's Krishi Vigyan Kendra suggested that Kadaknath or Kali Masi chicken could be healthy addition to the Indian Cricket Team.



SALIENT POINTS

- It was given GI tag last year.
- It is the local breed of chicken in Madhya Pradesh, which is completely black in color, feathers, flesh and even bones.
- It is traditionally reared by Jhabua's Adivasi communities.
- Cholesterol content is just about 0.73% to 1.05%, in comparison to 13% to 25% level in regular white chicken.
- It has very high levels of protein, iron and amino acids.
- It has low fat content.



483

ISSUE

Central Government Committee studied 9,589 Child Care Institutions and Homes, mostly run by NGOs, that come under the Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015.



SALIENT POINTS

- Most of the inmates are orphaned, abandoned, sexually abused, trafficked or victims of disasters and conflict.
- 32% are only registered under the JJ Act.
- There are improper facilities like no proper toilets, no secure compounds.
- Reform of this system can be achieved only through systematic scrutiny by the State Governments.

US scientists have calculated the total amount of plastic ever made and put the number at 8.3 billion tonnes.



SALIENT POINTS

The paper is authored by industrial ecologist from the University of California.



PLASTIC POLLUTION AND ALARM BELLS!

6 Total amount of plastic waste escaping to the oceans each year is 8 million tonnes. Some of it is getting into the food chain as fish and other marine creatures ingest small polymer fragments.



5 Current trends point to 12 billion tonnes of plastic waste by 2050.

FACTS AND FIGURES ABOUT PLASTIC

1 8,300 million tonnes of virgin plastics have been produced.

2 Half of this was made during the past 13 years.

3 Of the discarded plastic, only 9% is recycled. Some 12% has been incinerated, but 79% has gone to landfill.

4 Recycling is just 30% in Europe, 25% in China and 9% in USA.



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